**Subject:** FW: AI Innovation Fund Follow-up
**Date:** Friday, January 16, 2026 at 6:01:19 PM Eastern Standard Time
**From:** Pamela Brown
**To:** Justin Vazquez-Poritz, Maureen Archer-Festa, Hong Li, daniela viviana vladutescu, Cesar Salazar, Diana Samaroo, Douglas Moody, Esteban Beita Solano, Navid Allahverdi, David Smith, Yongchao Zhao, George Garrastegui
**CC:** Melanie Villatoro, Ivana Radivojevic Jovanovic, Mohammad Razani, Ashwin Satyanarayana, Sanjive Vaidya, Susan Brandt

Dear Colleagues,

Some great news to start the weekend! Congratulations to all of the AI Innovation Fund awardees.

Best regards,
Pam

Pamela Brown, PhD, PE
Provost and VP for Academic Affairs
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Book an online meeting 3-4 pm, M-F

| Proposal Title | Primary Contact Name | Award Total |
|---|---|---|
| Interdisciplinary AI Education Initiative in Civil and Computer Engineering Technology | Navid Allahverdi | $ 25,000 |
| Integrated AI Ethics and Immersive Blended Learning Initiative | Dr David B Smith | $ 25,000 |
| AI-Powered Assistant for Institutional Data | Yongchao Zhao | $ 24,939 |
| Design Hackathon | George Garrastegui, Jr. | $ 12,000 |
| Building AI Literacy Through Course Conversion in Sociology and Psychology | Maria Pagano | $ 13,500 |
| Integrating Artificial Intelligence in Architectural Representation and Design Education | Esteban Beita, Ph.D. | $ 24,000 |
| Infusing RAG, or Retrieval-Augmented Generation exercises into CTforAll.net | Prof. Douglas Moody | $ 21,000 |
| City Tech's Undergraduate Research and AI Integrity Initiative | Diana Samaroo | $ 15,000 |
| Project SmartStart at City Tech Nursing: AI-Powered Pre-Nursing Advising Pilot | Emerson Ea | $ 28,500 |
| CMCE AI Studio: Responsible AI Co-Pilots for Construction Documentation, CAD, and BIM | Cesar Salazar | $ 25,000 |
| AI Training of Faculty and implementation in Curriculum | Viviana Vladutescu | $ 25,000 |

Funds for the above projects will be sent to your college in the **February cert transfer.**

The remaining projects will not be funded.

The primary contact for each initiative, both those awarded and those not awarded, will receive a formal notification letter by Wednesday, January 21st. We appreciate your engagement, support, and insights. We are excited by the potential of these proposals to advance AI at CUNY.

Warm regards,

Evan

Evan Silberman, Ed.D
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For all scheduling requests, please email Francene Gordon-Norales